

Crossan Cooper

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Citizenship: United States of America

Fields of Concentration:

Public Economics
Labor Economics
Urban Economics
Economics of Education

Qualifying Examinations Completed:

2022 (Oral): Labor Economics, Public Finance
2021 (Written): Microeconomics, Macroeconomics

Dissertation Title: *Essays on Public Policy, Education Finance, and Human Capital*

Committee:

Professor Joseph Altonji (Chair)
Professor Winnie van Dijk
Professor John Eric Humphries
Professor Seth Zimmerman

Education:

Ph.D., Economics, Yale University, 2027 (Expected)
M.Phil., Economics, Yale University, 2023
M.A., Economics, Yale University, 2023
B.S., Mathematics and Economics, Davidson College, *magna cum laude*, 2020

Fellowships, Honors and Awards:

University Dissertation Fellowship, 2025-2026
Kingsley Trust Fellowship, 2025
UC Irvine Student Loan Law Institute Emerging Scholar, 2023
Cowles Foundation Fellowship, 2020-2025
Phi Beta Kappa, Davidson College, 2020

C Louise Nelson Scholar, Davidson College, 2020
AK Phifer Award for Excellence in Economics, Davidson College, 2020
William G McGavock Award for Excellence in Mathematics, Davidson College, 2020
Duncan Scholar, Davidson College, 2016-2020

Teaching Experience:

Fall 2022, Fall 2024, and Fall 2026, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Cormac O’Dea, Introductory Microeconomics, Yale College

Fall 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Steven Berry, Introductory Microeconomics, Yale College

Spring 2023, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Joseph Altonji, Introduction to Data Analysis and Econometrics, Yale College

Spring 2024, Teaching Assistant to Prof. Gerald Jaynes, Urban Inequalities and Educational Inequality, Yale College

Spring 2026, Teaching Assistant to Prof. John Eric Humphries, Introduction to Data Analysis and Econometrics, Yale College

Working Papers:

“Housing Assistance and Human Capital” (**Job Market Paper**)

“Where Does the Tide Roll? The Causes and Consequences of Out-of-State Enrollment at Public Flagships,” with Ryan Haygood

Abstract: Public flagship universities increasingly use nonresident tuition revenues to offset declining state funding. Nationally, we find that public flagships facing lower state support enroll relatively more high-income nonresidents. To understand how universities pursue this revenue margin and its downstream effects on graduates and state budgets, we link two decades of University of Alabama (UA) commencement records to admissions office recruiting visits and individual employment histories. We show UA boosts high-income out-of-state demand through targeted recruitment visits: two-way fixed-effects models show new visits generate 8–10% more future UA graduates. We then trace how nonresident enrollment redirects graduates across state labor markets. Exploiting variation in the state-of-origin composition of UA cohorts and a shift-share instrument, we estimate that every 100 out-of-state students cause 9–15 additional in-state students to leave the state after college. The resulting fiscal losses to Alabama are outweighed by tax revenues from out-of-state stayers and non-resident tuition margins: altogether, the median out-of-state student generates more than \$40,000 in lifetime state budget surplus. Finally, the out-of-state expansion appears to support in-state degree production. A budget accounting exercise shows that UA’s out-of-state enrollment margins are sufficient to cross-subsidize more than half of the in-state cohort.

Work In Progress:

“The Demand for Income Share Agreements,” with Constantine Yannelis

“Do SNAP Restrictions on Soda, Candy, and Energy Drinks Reduce Consumption? Evidence from State Bans and a Multi-Retailer Panel,” with Katja Seim and Jintaek Song

Seminar and Conference Presentations:

2026: Notre Dame, AEFPP Annual Meeting
2025: EEA Annual Meeting
2024: Moving Beyond Implications (University of Connecticut)
2023: EEA Annual Meeting

Languages:

English (native)

Software:

Expert: R, Python, SQL
Proficient: STATA, ArcGIS, MATLAB

References:

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